helper is designed to act on a specific tag and parse attribute values for data used during server-side processing to generate the resulting HTML. Most of the attributes the tag helper parses are custom and begin with `asp-`. As a reminder, the following is the anchor tag helper you added to the site navigation for the Welcome page:

```
<a class="nav-link text-dark" asp-area="" asp-page="/Welcome">Welcome</a>
```

The `asp-area` and `asp-page` attributes are custom attributes. Their role is to provide information to the anchor tag helper about the `area` and `page` the tag helper should use to generate a URL. You will look at `area`s in the next chapter, when you explore routing and URLs. When the anchor tag helper has finished processing and the tag is rendered as HTML, the generated URL will appear as a standard `href` attribute. The custom attributes are not rendered.

ENABLING TAG HELPERS

Tag helpers are an opt-in feature. They are not enabled by default; although, if you start with the standard project template, they are enabled globally within the _ViewImports .cshtml file located in the Pages folder by the following line of code:

```
@addTagHelper *, Microsoft.AspNetCore.Mvc.TagHelpers
```

The `addTagHelper` directive takes two arguments: the tag helpers to enable and the name of the assembly containing the tag helpers to enable. The wildcard character (`*`) specifies that all tag helpers in the specified assembly should be enabled. The framework tag helpers are located in `Microsoft.AspNetCore.Mvc.TagHelpers`, which is why you see the name of this assembly added by default. You can create your own custom tag helpers. This book won't cover that, but if your custom tag helper belonged to the WebApplication1 project, you would enable it as follows:

```
@addTagHelper *, WebApplication1
```